PEC - JBE QUESTIONS - 05 05 2025

Thank you for your questions. Please find individual responses below. To provide helpful context, the following overview outlines the broader process and framework currently underway.

Board Resolution 6861 directs the Superintendent to identify the tasks necessary to find the location for a new headquarters and operations center, including developing Minimum Criteria. In response, staff have developed a set of Minimum Criteria designed to ensure that any prospective site can support the core operational needs of PPS at one or more locations. It is important to view this step as the *beginning* of the process—not its conclusion. The next phase involves identifying properties that meet, or come close to meeting, the established criteria followed by a robust property evaluation.

It is unlikely that any single property will satisfy all criteria perfectly. Therefore, each candidate site will need to be assessed holistically, with careful consideration of how well it aligns with PPS's functional needs. The Board will play a key role in this evaluation, providing guidance to Staff throughout the process. Additionally PEC staff will continue to play a key role and provide input as properties are considered and PPS completes "test fits" - preliminary space planning assessments to determine whether specific properties can accommodate current operations. All property actions will adhere to the requirements of Policy 8.70.040 Preservation, Maintenance and Disposition of District Real Property and **must be approved by the Board through a formal resolution.** If the process does not yield a suitable property, the **Board reserves the right to decide that the PPS headquarters will remain at its current location.**

About the Minimum Criteria

The criteria were intentionally designed to balance specificity and flexibility. They are specific enough to exclude properties that clearly do not meet PPS's fundamental needs, yet broad enough to ensure potentially viable sites are not dismissed prematurely. Staff were careful not to be overly restrictive, recognizing that suitable relocation options may be unique or unforeseen.

Next Steps: Property Search and Evaluation

The property search phase will begin upon Board approval of the Minimum Criteria, and site evaluations will begin once candidate properties have been identified. The process will focus on identifying and assessing real options against the criteria, with the goal of finding the most suitable location—or locations—for PPS's future needs. Through a series of meetings and communications during this process, the project team will obtain staff input and the Board will be consulted to evaluate options and direct the Superintendent. As noted above all real property binding agreements will be approved by the Board via resolution, following significant input in advance of such decisions.

Questions from J. Brim-Edwards about the Staff Recommendation on Minimum Criteria

1. Meeting Current Functionality: Does the Minimum Criteria Project staff is recommending meet the baseline requirements that "reflect the current functionality of PEC operations in order to replace the functions that are currently housed within PEC." (Section 2.02 of the Operating Agreement.

Conceptually, yes. The Minimum Criteria explicitly state that the new facilities must support the full programming currently at PEC, including on-site workspace for every Central Office employee, equivalent boardroom capacity, operations space (including warehouse, shops, and nutrition services), and other core functions. These criteria were based on a detailed space and programming evaluation and designed to ensure full continuity of services.

That said, simply meeting square footage requirements does not ensure a facility will function effectively for PPS. One example: an important consideration when assessing warehouse space is the building's *clear height*—the usable vertical space within the facility—which plays a critical role in determining overall storage efficiency. Based on our analysis approximately 270,000 cubic feet of space is needed to support current storage and flexible-use requirements. This volume however includes only the racking systems and the aisles between them. Depending on a different warehouse's clear height, the amount of floor area required to achieve this volume varies:

- 30' Clear Height: Requires 33,000 SF of usable racking and circulation area, resulting in a total warehouse footprint of 144,000 SF (gross).
- 20' Clear Height: Requires 35,775 SF of usable space, equating to 150,468 SF (gross).
- 16' Clear Height: Requires 42,299 SF of usable space, increasing the gross warehouse size to 157,765 SF.

Because properties can potentially meet all minimum requirements but still not meet PPS's functional needs, considered sites will undergo robust analysis during the property evaluation phase, including completion of "test fits" to determine functionality of specific spaces. Test fits may include:

- Analyzing the layout of the property (floor plans, dimensions, column spacing, etc.).
- Overlaying operational requirements, such as office spaces, equipment areas, production zones, meeting rooms, restrooms, boardroom, and warehouse/storage needs.
- Determining spatial efficiency and adjacencies—whether the operations can function effectively within the available square footage.
- Identifying major modifications that might be needed (e.g., wall removals, additions, infrastructure upgrades).
- Providing a visual layout (sometimes through CAD drawings or sketches) showing how operations could "fit" into the property.
- Consulting with work groups that would use particular space.

2. Co-Location: In the Executive Summary of the Report 01-08, there are three Schemes outlined, Scheme 1 is one Headquarters with functions co-located and Schemes 2 and 3 are variations of the Administration and Operations in separate locations. The Summary says that "Portland Public Schools preference is to remain in a similar model as the existing Prophet Center, Scheme 1, where all the departments are co-located in one facility." In addition, on page 01-04 of the Executive Summary it states that in all peer districts with the exception of one, "co-location of administrative and operational

functions was seen as ideal". If this is the preference why is that not stated as a "Desired Feature" or a preference in the site identification and selection?

The minimum criteria were developed to strike a balance between specificity and flexibility. Preliminary review of the PPS commercial market suggests that finding a single location to house both the Office and Operations Center is unlikely—and possibly unfeasible. Therefore restricting the criteria to only colocation opportunities unnecessarily eliminates potential properties.

That said, certain site characteristics are clearly preferred. Many of these preferences, including the ideal of a combined location, are outlined in the supporting documentation and will inform the site evaluation phase moving forward. Other preferences will likely be identified during the property search and evaluation process. I expect that a number of "new" preferred characteristics will be identified during property search and evaluation.

3. Central Location: The 2024 report to the Board has any relocated facilities within the district boundary. The Executive Summary peer district themes highlights that "a central location is critical to operations, preferably with proximity to freeways for efficient district-wide access." The new proposed Minimum Requirements don't require the Operations Center to be in the district boundary. If a centralized location is needed, how can the Minimum Criteria for the Operation Center be outside of the PPS boundaries? Further, Board Resolution 6861, Resolved 2a states "The criteria for each shall include, but not limited to, that the new Headquarters reside with the District Boundaries…" Why does the proposed Minimum Criteria not aligned with Board Resolution 6861?

As with question #2, the recommended minimum criteria were intentionally crafted to balance specificity with flexibility. While a central location is preferred—and generally, the closer to the city center, the better—imposing a strict geographic radius (e.g., within X miles of the city center) could unnecessarily narrow the range of viable options and exclude promising sites prematurely. We encourage Board Members to identify and flag any specific relocation characteristics - such as location, travel time, or other key characteristics - for careful consideration during property search and evaluation. These inputs will help staff conduct targeted analyses and provide informed recommendations during the site evaluation phase.

Note: it's conceivable that a location outside the district could be better suited - shorter travel times, easier access, proximity to transit and freeways - than a location within the district.

4. Operating Costs: In the Executive Summary for the Peer Districts, it states: "Multiple locations increase operating costs and impact communications and organizational cohesion." Has PPS estimated the increase in annual operating costs of operating two locations? (For example, the initial 2024 COBALT/Bainbridge report has duplication of Security and Office of Technology and Information Systems at both locations.)

Staff acknowledge that utilizing multiple locations will likely lead to increased operational costs. However, the extent of these costs—and any potential savings from other favorable property

characteristics—will vary significantly depending on the specific sites under consideration. These factors will be thoroughly assessed during the site evaluation phase.

5. Desired Features: In the Operating Agreement approved by the Board, "Article 2.03, Desired Features" it states that "additional Desired Features separate from the Minimum Requirements ("Desired Features") may also be established by PPS and utilized in selecting, designing and improving the Relocation sites…" What are the Desired Features that PPS has developed for the Relocation Site and given they are to inform the site selection process shouldn't they be presented to the Board with the Minimum Criteria for approval? (Section 2.04)

Desired features have not been formalized. However, staff input results suggest priorities including co-location, free and more on-site parking, safety, in-building amenities, access to food services, proximity to public transportation, and central access. These features align closely with the intent of the minimum criteria, even if they are not listed separately. Staff input, both during development of the Minimum Criteria, and during the property evaluation process will inform future staff recommendations and Board discussions.

6. In the survey, focus groups, and comments of responding PEC staff, features prioritized for many employees/workers are:

- *Colocation (68% of the employees want to be co-located, with 78% saying that is more efficient).*
- *Free on-site parking*
- *Safety and Security*
- *Central Location/Accessibility for a significant share of employees*
- *Welcoming and convenient to the public*

Share how the Minimum Criteria and (the yet to be shared?) Desired Features align with PEC staff concerns and priorities.

The Relocation Team has engaged PEC staff through various channels since the early stages of planning, including all-staff surveys, in-person Q&A sessions, interviews with department leads, sharing regular updates, and providing opportunities for direct submission of questions and feedback. We also acknowledge that not all of the staff input has directly translated to the recommended minimum criteria. This does not mean that the input is not valued or considered. Some of the input is directly reflected in the minimum criteria, whereas others are captured in the materials to help guide future property evaluation. PEC staff will continue to be important stakeholders throughout the relocation process.

7. Work Space/Functionality in the Operations Center: With the comparator districts, the consultants didn't provide disaggregated workforce data. Please provide that. To our lnowldege A district that

contracts out maintenance and other work needs less space and it would be useful to understand the workforce comparators among the peer districts. Also number of buildings and schools and average age of building fleet.

Answer:None of the districts that we spoke with had significant outsourcing. Some did have swing shift operations, however these were employed staff. This could affect parking and space configurations.

- *In the documents p. 03-05, there is a reference to "Industry Standards". Please provide the industry standards that are referenced? Do they apply to an in-house workforce with aging public facilities or is it a private sector standard or the standard for new buildings and new systems?*

Mackenzie took into account such industry standards as ISO 9001 and OSHA safety standards for fabrication and warehouse. Mackenzie also utilized their 50 years of experience with warehouse facilities to ensure that they addressed PPS's specific needs and operations. These standards could increase or decrease spacing for pedestrian walkways, equipment clearances, etc.

- *There is a significant reduction in all of the shop spaces. Do the workers in the Multi-Craft Workshop, Mechanical Shop, Electric Shop, Music Shop, Warehouse and Nutrition Services agree that their work space can be reduced – in some cases dramatically -- and still have the same functionality required in the Operating Agreement? (p. 03-05)*

Fabrication, Shop, and Maintenance representatives acknowledged that they can reduce their overall shop and fabrication areas by 30%, which would be comparable to peer districts. In multiple discussions with staff, we discussed equipments/machinery that are no longer required, and cataloguing existing equipment and parts so that they are more efficiently found and utilized.

- *Given the age of our equipment, systems and buildings, PPS trades staff keep spare parts on hand as replacement parts aren't available for our systems or equipment. In the McKenzie and Bainbridge report, they determined that 25% or more of parts and equipment could be purged. What was that based on and was it validated by workers in those shops?*

This is consistent with the Seattle School District. They have similar aged facilities and resource constraints. The consultant team conducted interviews with all Chief's and/or department representatives to verify existing office and storage space, identify other misc. needs, gather detailed information, and toured existing spaces to assess current conditions. There are also other ways to efficiently store the equipment.

- *Unlike a few of the comparator districts who have new systems and can replace with new, easy to locate parts and thus don't need parts on hand, PPS and other districts have aging systems and equipment and need to secure, store and repurpose replacement parts on site. Share how PPS can make the reductions in parts and space with its model of working.*

Based on interviews with department heads/leads, not all of the spare parts that are currently being stored are likely needed.

- *There is little mention of Nutrition Services and their needs in terms of work space and functionality.*

PPS Nutrition services was widely recognized by peer districts as the standard for best practices, and therefore no significant changes were considered at this stage of the process. Their request was a smaller kitchen the size of Lincoln HS, but with more efficient storage and dedicated storage for nutrition services.

8. Administration Space Reductions versus Operations Space Reductions in the Minimum Criteria: Share any reduction in current space requirements to the Minimum Criteria (as was done for the operations staff) for administrative staff and the reductions for Chiefs/Sr. Directors/Directors and other classes of employees in the Administrative Space. On page 01-03 of the "PEC Space and Programming Evaluation" Report the chart does not show new Minimum Criteria for Administrative Space, however, page 01-07 there is a 1.5-2.5% reduction in Administrative Gross Square Feet and a 24-25% Reduction in the Operations Center Gross Square Feet Reduction.

Answer: PEC has many and varied sizes of cube and office spaces. The reductions in space are achieved by assuming a more efficient floorplan (e.g., no open air atriums) and standardizing offices and cube sizes. It assumes all staff who were here in March 2025 (e.g., does not include current RIF numbers). It does not change our current standard of all positions - director and higher - qualify for an office. The Minimum Criteria also proposes a more efficient layout and workflow, but we will not know if that is possible until we do a test fit.

9. Safety and Security. This is a priority for staff. How will safety and security be defined? In the Friday meeting, I was told it was crime statistics and lighting. Please provide a more expansive definition.

- *Share the work shift hours generally of different groups of employees who work at PEC.*

- *Employees currently can get escorts to their cars if it is a late shift. Given that the parking proposed in the Minimum Criteria potentially would require many employees to find other offsite parking or wait at transit stops at night is PPS prepared to have security personnel escort people to offsite parking and wait at transit stops with employees. What about parents, students and staff who attend evening Board meetings if there is not available onsite parking?*

Safety is an example of a PEC staff priority that is directly reflected in the Minimum Criteria. The evaluation of safety will vary based on the specific attributes of each site under consideration. Relevant safety-related factors may include: location of parking, amount of isolation of building, crime statistics. The current location of PEC has significant safety issues and concerns, and we look forward to working with our partners in security in evaluating new locations.

- Crime rates in the surrounding area
- Secured perimeter and parking areas
- Building access control systems
- Adequate site lighting
- Traffic safety and visibility
- Proximity to emergency services

Given that perceptions of physical safety can vary among individuals, PEC staff input will be essential in assessing the safety of potential properties to ensure concerns are thoroughly addressed and reflected in the evaluation process.

10. Parking: Based on Friday's discussion, the Minimum Criteria assumes a 104 parking spaces for the Admin Building and 200 for the Operations Center, significantly below the current 549 parking spaces (owned and leased) and the assumed staff count of 691.

- *How many of those 300 parking spaces would be for visiting staff or community/family visitors? If there were only 100 parking spaces for the Admin Building, many admin building staff and families/staff who visit the PPS Admin building would have access to offsite parking and need to pay for it. Is that the expectation of PPS project leaders?*
- *Does PPS have estimations of daily/evening visitors to PEC? Same question for the Operations Center although visitors are generally not families.*
- *Is the Minimum Criteria parking assumed to be no-cost parking? It doesn't specify that one way or another.*
- *Share the number of PEC currently taking transit regularly (3-4x a week) to work at the PEC?*
- *PPS doesn't provide free transit passes to employees who can utilize public transportation, correct?*
- *Share a scattergram of where the current PEC staff live?*
- *In addition to free parking, senior district staff also have a monthly transportation stipend. How much is that and who receives it a PEC?*

As outlined in the Staff Memo, the PEC currently provides 318 onsite parking spaces (including the gravel parking lot across Dixon St) for staff and visitors, serving both the Office and Operations Center functions. The Minimum Criteria recognize that these two functions have different parking needs and therefore assign parking requirements based on building area:

- Office: 2 spaces per 1,000 square feet
- Operations Center: 1 space per 1,000 square feet

The total number of onsite parking spaces will vary depending on the configuration and size of each functional area. For example, under Scheme 2:

- Office (113,554 SF): 226 parking spaces
- Operations Center (168,121 SF): 168 parking spaces
- Total parking: 394 onsite spaces

In addition to onsite parking, PPS currently has access to 171 offsite spaces through leases and in-kind service agreements. While the Minimum Criteria focus on characteristics of new properties, it is acknowledged that PPS may need to continue using a "hybrid" parking model. This could include a combination of onsite spaces, leased parking, or alternative solutions such as parking stipends. The specific mix will depend on the candidate sites and the availability of viable nearby options, to be evaluated during the site selection process.

Note: staff are looking into the additional requests for information such as who has parking stipends and a scattergram of PEC home locations.

11. Warehouse, Loading Docks and Transport: The Minimum Criteria replaces the current 25 covered loading docks with 10 uncovered loading docks and a loading zones. Describe the process by which the determination was made that only 10 loading docks were needed and that PPS should not ask for the current functionality of "covered loading docks" to keep materials, books, and other transported good out of rain and weather? Note the 2024 initial COBALT/Bainbridge Minimum Criteria said that the Operations Center requires 25 raised dock bays of varying specificity and 6 loading doors for the trades shop functions. Why has the Minimum Criteria been significantly reduced? Was the workforce using the loading docks and the proposed new "loading zone" consulted on the functionality of the Minimum Criteria?

Answer: While PPS has 25 bays, we do not utilize all the bays for daily loading/unloading. A covered bay only provides a dry area for the parked vehicle. The shipped goods loading/ unloading occurs within the covered warehouse space, and is protected from weather. Given the compressed time frame of 60 days, the cobalt report stated what we currently have, but did not have time for deeper analysis.

12. Shifts in Recommendations: The 2024 report from COBALT/Bainbridge had these recommendations for Minimum Criteria for the Admin and the Operations Center:

- *Both locations: "Location within the district boundaries and centrally located on average within three miles reach of its nine high schools."*

Answer: centrally located to freeways and major arterials is a better indicator of efficiency than miles. We will model drive times for maintenance, nutrition services etc. This is an area where staff in the field will be critical in evaluating potential locations.

- *Parking at the Admin building: "Meets parking needs such that our students, families and staff are not burdened with parking costs. Includes sufficient stalls within the property*

footprint for the safety of staff and in and out. Ample well-lit and secure visitor and staff parking within a two-block radius."

Answer: two blocks may be farther than we want staff to travel. Appropriate offsite parking has many considerations and we don't want to create an artificial measure that may not be appropriate.

- *Safety: "PPS employees and visitors would be safe on site and in the surrounding areas during both the daylight and darkness. Property crime is not a significant issue in the area"*

Answer: addressed above. Crime statistics and working with Security and PPB in evaluating locations will be important.

- *Accessibility for the Admin Building: "Within one mile of the Operations Center."*

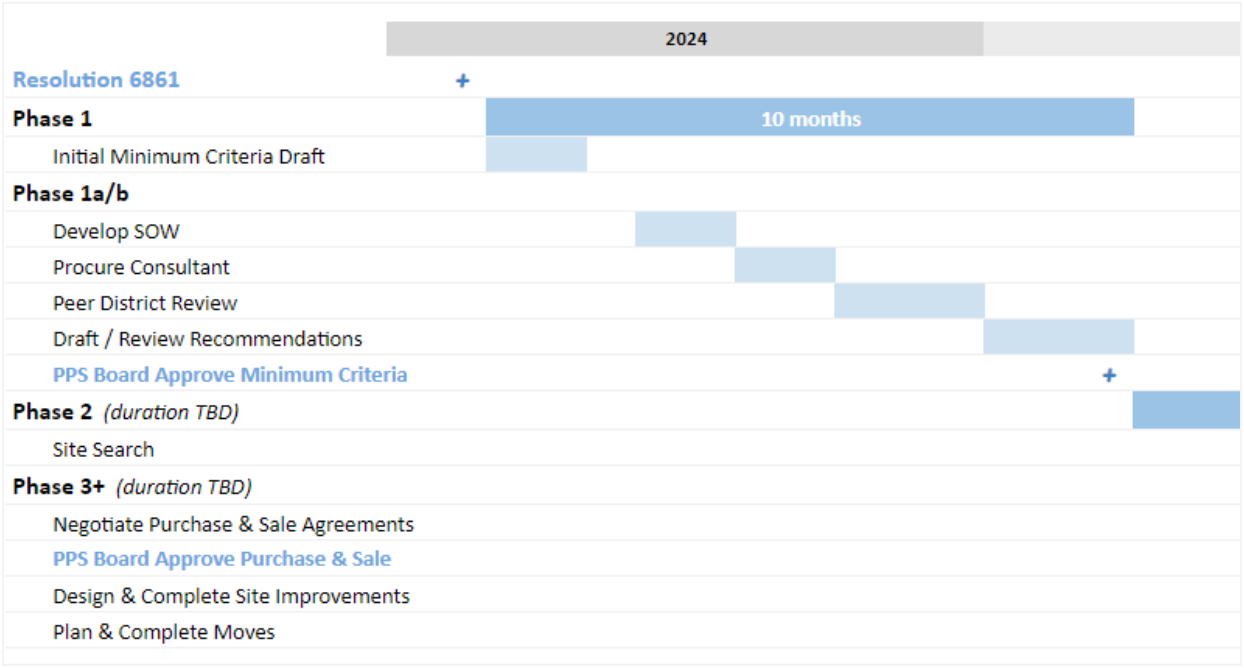
Answer: Travel between locations is more appropriately considered in terms of time at peak travel times and are dependent on ease of parking and accessibility.

The new Minimum Criteria deviate from these initial recommendations or are silent on these topics. Share specifically why there is a new or different recommendation or why the new recommendations don't include these provisions.

Given the compressed time frame of 60 days, the cobalt report stated what we currently have, but did not have time for deeper analysis.

13. Public Information/Board Reporting: Board Resolution 6861 also states that "PPS Facilities and Asset Management staff and/or Senior PPS Leadership will provide regular updates at the Facilities and Operations Committee of the School Board." I couldn't find a School Board Committee meeting on this topic since at least last year. Please share the dates of the Committee meetings in the last year on the Minimum Criteria or the Operating Agreement as I would like to review the documents.

The SFIOC met numerous times in 2024, however the majority of those meetings focused on GO bond planning. The SFIOC has not met in 2025. The last PEC relocation update was provided to the Board in October 2024 and included the below preliminary timeline.



14. Workforce Communication: Confirming that prior to the posting of the Board materials and as late as Friday, May 2, no communications about the final Minimum Requirements or Desired Features being proposed to the Board had been broadly shared with staff working in PEC, including both represented and nonrepresented employees.

A staff communication was sent Monday (May 5).

15. Future Engagement PEC workforce: Will represented (e.g. DCU, PFSP, SEIU and others) and non-represented employees have access to inform and be consulted on "test fits" of potential sites and matches on Minimum Criteria and Desired Features? Will the test fit and site selection be transparent to the Board, PEC staff and public?

Yes, PEC staff and Board input will be essential to the property evaluation process.

16. Board Oversight: Will the Board be provided information in public sessions (versus Executive Sessions) so that this is a transparent real estate transaction and the Board can provide continued financial oversight and ensure that the functionality of the school district's central office support for our schools during the relocation.

The Board, staff, and PPS community will receive updates through public meetings and other communication channels. There may also be executive sessions with the Board if Board Leadership agrees that is needed.